

INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 155 · HOT

Zenity

Cybersecurity · AI Agent Security & Governance · New York (commercial) · Tel Aviv (R&D); founded 2021 · Private (valuation undisclosed; \$125M Series C, Aug 2026)

Zenity, the AI-agent security company founded in Tel Aviv and run commercially from New York, announced a \$125M Series C led by Norwest on 3 August, with SoftBank Vision Fund 2, Hitachi Ventures and LG Technology Ventures joining. Total funding is about \$185M; the valuation was not disclosed.

72

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Cadillac F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

Qumra Capital joined the new investors; Vertex Ventures, Third Point Ventures, DTCP and Intel Capital returned. The \$38M Series B, co-led by Third Point and DTCP with Microsoft's M12, closed in October 2024. In April Gartner named Zenity 'the company to beat' in AI agent governance. Founders Ben Kliger and Michael Bargury built security products together at Microsoft; the company now employs more than 230 people, about 150 in Israel, runs sales, marketing and operations from New York, and counts Fortune 500 and Global 2000 enterprises, SoftBank Corp among them, as customers.

Every AI agent an enterprise deploys, from Microsoft Copilot to custom builds, acts with someone's permissions; Zenity inventories them, limits what they can reach and detects when their intent drifts. The grid has bought defence in depth, CrowdStrike at Mercedes, Bitdefender at Ferrari, Keeper at Williams, Rubrik at McLaren, but nobody has bought the agent layer. The Norwest-led Series C funds exactly the global expansion a sponsorship serves.

WHY NOW

The Series C closed on 3 August with a global-expansion mandate, and Gartner's April verdict gives the brand a window to own its category before rivals catch up. The United States GP in Austin (late October) and Las Vegas (November) sit inside the horizon; teams settle 2027 rosters in the fourth quarter.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$125M

\$125M Series C led by Norwest, announced 3 Aug 2026; total funding about \$185M (company; Fortune reports \$1...

\$185M

Total funding is about \$185M;

\$38M

The \$38M Series B, co-led by Third Point and DTCP with Microsoft's M12, closed in October 2024.

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 49 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Cadillac F1 Team	PRIME LANE	greenfield entry — partner roster being built from zero
Mercedes-AMG Petronas F1 Team	TAKEN	CrowdStrike
McLaren Mastercard F1 Team	TAKEN	Cisco
Atlassian Williams Racing	TAKEN	Keeper

BOTTOM LINE

A \$125M Series C led by Norwest, with SoftBank, Hitachi and LG, Gartner's 'company to beat' verdict and an untouched agent-security lane at the American debutant put Zenity in a window to buy category ownership, with Austin and Las Vegas inside it. An undisclosed valuation, no marketing officer and Cadillac's price point hold the score at 72.

WHY CADILLAC F1 TEAM

Cadillac's debut roster has TWG AI as exclusive AI partner, Core Scientific for the data centre and IFS for enterprise software, and no cybersecurity partner, so the agent-security lane is clean. A team assembling its estate in 2026 is adopting agents inside Copilot and its own AI programme at the same moment, with no legacy controls to retrofit. Zenity's New York commercial base and Fortune 500 customer list match an American flag-bearer selling to enterprise CIOs.

VALUE TO CADILLAC F1 TEAM — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - operational. Zenity inventories every AI agent in the team's estate and what each can reach; enforces least privilege before an agent touches design, supplier or strategy data; and watches agent behaviour at runtime for prompt injection and intent drift. For a first-season team standing up Copilot beside an exclusive AI programme, it is the control layer that lets engineers use agents without exposing the car.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official AI Security Partner, in the cybersecurity category. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, covering the expansion the Series C funds. Estimated \$2-4M a year, part in platform licences. Scope: garage and car placement, an 'agents in the garage' content series, Austin and Las Vegas hospitality for CISOs and CIOs, a Cadillac reference deployment.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Ben Kliger
CEO & CO-FOUNDER, ZENITY · **VERIFIED**

Kliger co-founded Zenity in 2021 with CTO Michael Bargury after leading security products together at Microsoft, is based in New York. Path: Bargury, and Keren Herscovici, VP Finance and Corporate Development. No chief marketing officer is listed; marketing is led at director level (reported).

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with Gartner and the empty agent lane.

“Ben, Gartner says you are the company to beat, and no Formula 1 team has an AI-agent security partner. Cadillac is building its estate from zero this year. 25 minutes before Austin to see what that lane is worth?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 17 / 20 Round announced 3 Aug; Austin and Las Vegas inside the window.	CAPACITY 14 / 20 \$125M raise, ~\$185M total; valuation undisclosed; 230 staff.	BRAND FIT 14 / 20 B2B security brand; CIO and CISO audience; New York base.	URGENCY 12 / 20 Category race after Gartner's verdict; no hard deadline.	OPS FIT 15 / 20 MODE A: agent inventory and control for a greenfield estate.
--	--	--	---	---

RISKS & COUNTERS

TWG AI EXCLUSIVITY TWG AI is Cadillac's exclusive AI partner; an 'AI security' brand could be read as an AI partner and blocked. **Counter:** Enter as cybersecurity, position Zenity as agent governance, and clear the language with TWG first.

SCALE AND PRICE About \$185M raised, no disclosed valuation and no marketing officer; Cadillac's 'fewer, bigger, better' policy is priced for larger cheques. **Counter:** Part-pay in licences the team would buy anyway and step fees up over the three years.

SOURCES — 14 OF 14 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

- https://zenity.io/company-overview/newsroom/company-news/zenity-raises-125-million-to-secure-the-era-of-1-billion-ai-agents
- https://www.calcalistech.com/ctechnews/article/blahbbcbfe